

One of my first encounters with giants was also the last thing I did at my old friend (and former foe) MordenKainen's side. He claims to this day that no cleric was available to restore me to life, only a druid, but he can't hide his smirk when he says it.

—Bigby

CHAPTER 1

CHARACTER CREATION

MOST ADVENTURERS HAVE HEARD TALES of giants and their ilk. But for some adventurers, their connection to giants runs deeper than fanciful stories.

This chapter is for any D&D character who aspires to forge a link to the mighty giants. From sources of havoc-wreaking power to the artful study of rune magic, from boons that imbue an individual with giant-like might to fantastic tales that can shape an adventurer's entire life—giants can make both big and small impacts on a character's story.

The following sections present a variety of options for creating characters with ties to giants:

"Subclass Option" allows barbarians to explore ties to the nature of giants.

"Backgrounds" presents two new backgrounds: the giant foundling and the rune carver. These backgrounds represent formative years spent studying and living among giants, and they grant access to feats that represent that experience.

"Big Heroes, Big Stories" includes inspiration for narratively connecting characters to giants, regardless of their class or background.

"Feats" provides options for players who wish to link their characters to giants and primordial magic.

Subclass Option

This section presents one new subclass option: the Path of the Giant for the barbarian.

Barbarian: Path of the Giant

Barbarians who walk the Path of the Giant draw strength from the same primal forces as giants. As they rage, these barbarians surge with elemental power and grow in size, taking on forms that evoke the glory of giants. Some barbarians look like oversized versions of themselves, perhaps with a hint of elemental energy flaring in their eyes and around their weapons. Others transform more dramatically, taking on the appearance of an actual giant or a form similar to an Elemental, wreathed in fire, frost, or lightning.

Giant's Power

3rd-Level Path of the Giant Feature

When you choose this path, you learn to speak, read, and write Giant or one other language of your choice if you already know Giant. Additionally, you learn a cantrip of your choice: either *druidcraft* or *thaumaturgy*. Wisdom is your spellcasting ability for this spell.

Giant's Havoc

3rd-Level Path of the Giant Feature

Your rages pull strength from the primal might of giants, transforming you into a hulking force of destruction. While raging, you gain the following benefits:

Crushing Throw. When you make a successful ranged attack with a thrown weapon using Strength, you can add your Rage Damage bonus to the attack's damage roll.

Giant Stature. Your reach increases by 5 feet, and if you are smaller than Large, you become Large, along with anything you are wearing. If there isn't enough room for you to increase your size, your size doesn't change.

Elemental Cleaver

6th-Level Path of the Giant Feature

Your bond with the elemental might of giants grows, and you learn to infuse weapons with primordial energy.

When you enter your rage, you can choose one weapon that you are holding and infuse it with one of the following damage types: acid, cold, fire, thunder, or lightning. While you wield the infused weapon during your rage, the weapon's damage type changes to the chosen type, it deals an extra

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1d6 damage of the chosen type when it hits, and it gains the thrown property, with a normal range of 20 feet and a long range of 60 feet. If you throw the weapon, it reappears in your hand the instant after it hits or misses a target. The infused weapon's benefits are suppressed while a creature other than you wields it.

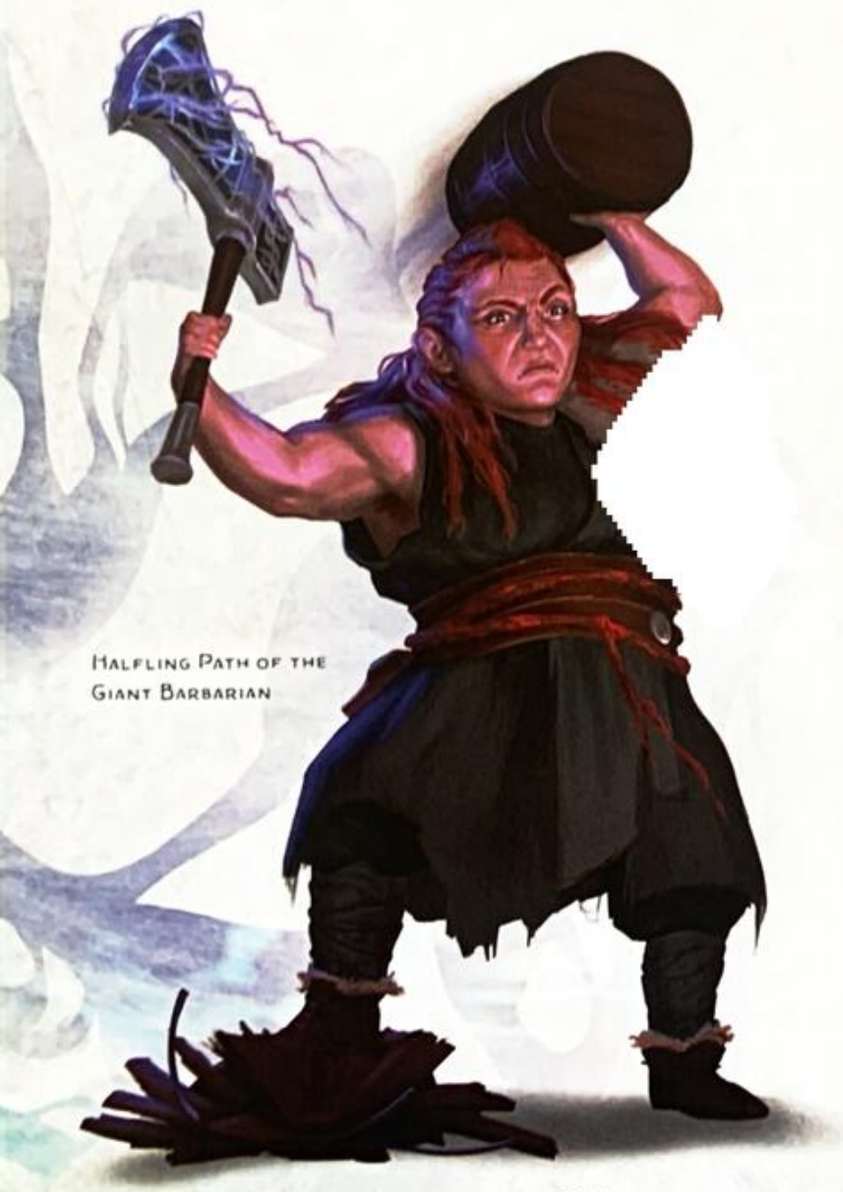
While raging and holding the infused weapon, you can use a bonus action to change the infused weapon's current damage type to another one from the damage type options above.

Mighty Impel

10th-Level Path of the Giant Feature

Your connection to giant strength allows you to hurl both allies and enemies on the battlefield. As a bonus action while raging, you can choose one Medium or smaller creature within your reach and move it to an unoccupied space you can see within 30 feet of yourself. An unwilling creature must succeed on a Strength saving throw (DC equals 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Strength modifier) to avoid the effect.

If, at the end of this movement, the thrown creature isn't on a surface or liquid that can support it, the creature falls, taking damage as normal and landing prone.



Halfling Path of the Giant Barbarian

Demiurgic Colossus

14th-Level Path of the Giant Feature

The primordial power of your rage intensifies. When you rage, your reach increases by 10 feet, your size can increase to Large or Huge (your choice), and you can use your Mighty Impel to move creatures that are Large or smaller.

In addition, the extra damage dealt by your Elemental Cleaver feature increases to 2d6.

Backgrounds

This section presents two backgrounds that provide options linking characters to the ancient magic of giants. The giant foundling background represents a life spent around titanic creatures and their supernatural might. The rune carver background reflects a history of studying the ancient traditions of giants' runecraft.

Bonus Feats

If the DM decides to allow the giant foundling and rune carver backgrounds, all characters in the campaign gain access to a bonus feat. If you select one of those backgrounds, you gain the bonus feat specified in that background. If the background you choose doesn't provide a feat, you gain a bonus feat of your choice from the following list (these feats appear in the *Player's Handbook*):

- Skilled
- Tough

Giant Foundling

Though you aren't a Giant, you grew up among giants. Maybe you were an orphan taken in by a sympathetic family of stone giants who raised you as one of their own. Or perhaps you lived in a lost prehistoric pocket of the world, surrounded by giants and fearsome behemoths or hulking dinosaurs.

Something about your environment—perhaps the food or water that sustained you, elemental magic inherent in the site of your home, or some verdant blessing of growth placed on you—caused you to grow to a remarkable size for your kind. With the aid of this magic, you have learned how to embody the might of giants. You are used to moving through a world much bigger than you, and that is reflected in your skills, attitude, and perspective on life.

Skill Proficiencies: Intimidation, Survival
Languages: Giant and one other language of your choice
Equipment: A backpack, a set of traveler's clothes, a small stone or sprig that reminds you of home, and a pouch containing 10 gp



A GIANT FOUNDLING IS USED TO A LARGER WORLD.

Origin Stories

How you came to live among colossal creatures is up to you to determine, but the Foundling Origin table suggests a variety of possibilities.

Foundling Origin

d6	Origin
1	You were found as a baby by a family of nomadic giants who raised you as one of their own.
2	A family of stone giants rescued you when you fell into a mountain chasm, and you have lived with them underground ever since.
3	You were lost or abandoned as a child in a jungle that teemed with ravenous dinosaurs. There, you found an equally lost frost giant; together, you survived.
4	Your farm was crushed and your family killed in a battle between warring groups of giants. Racked with guilt over the destruction, a sympathetic giant soldier promised to care for you.
5	After you had a series of strange dreams as a child, your superstitious parents sent you to study with a powerful but aloof storm giant oracle.
6	While playing hide-and-seek with your friends, you stumbled into the castle of a cloud giant, who immediately adopted you.

Feature: Strike of the Giants

You gain the Strike of the Giants feat (described later in this chapter).

Building a Giant Foundling Character

Your life among giants has given you a unique perspective. Though you are unusually large for your kind, you're no larger than a giant child, so you might be very mindful of your size.

Suggested Characteristics. The Giant Foundling Personality Traits table suggests a variety of traits you might adopt for your character.

Giant Foundling Personality Traits

d6	Personality Trait
1	What I lack in stature compared to giants, I make up for with sheer spite.
2	I insist on being taken seriously as a full-grown adult. Nobody talks down to me!
3	Crowded spaces make me uncomfortable. I'd much rather be in an open field than a bustling tavern.
4	I embrace my shorter stature. It helps me stay unnoticed—and underestimated.
5	Every avalanche begins as a single pebble.
6	The world always feels too big, and I'm afraid I'll never find my place in it.

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> What we call rune magic is the palest imitation of Annam's creative work. He shaped worlds from the primal elements; we struggle to bind the merest scraps of elemental power into the mystic shapes of our runes.
>
> —Diancastra

Rune Carver

You've dedicated your life to studying runecraft. Whether you were taught by a master rune carver or learned by poring over ancient engravings, you can tap into the supernatural power held within runes.

The art of runecraft was initially created by giants, but over time, the practice has been adopted by many peoples. As such, though Giant runes are the most commonly used, many rune carvers incorporate symbols from their native languages into the craft.

Skill Proficiencies: History, Perception
Tool Proficiencies: One set of artisan's tools
Languages: Giant
Equipment: A set of artisan's tools (one of your choice), a small knife, a whetstone, a set of common clothes, and a pouch containing 10 gp

Rune Styles

Each rune carver has a unique style and preferred medium. To determine how you make your runes, you can roll on the Rune Style table.

Rune Style

d6	Style
1	You inscribe runes in wax or clay with a fine metal needle.
2	You whittle pieces of wood into small figurines you mark with runes.
3	You engrave runes onto glass beads and thread them onto necklaces and bracelets.
4	You stitch runes into the hems of clothing.
5	You carve runes on a set of animal bones you can throw in different formations.
6	You draw runes into candles, melting the wax to smooth over the engravings.

Feature: Rune Shaper

You gain the Rune Shaper feat (described later in this chapter).



Orc Rune Carver

Building a Rune Carver Character

Scholarly pursuits, ancient mysteries, or a fateful encounter might inspire a character to pursue the secrets of a rune carver.

Suggested Characteristics. The Rune Carver Personality Traits table suggests a variety of traits you might adopt for your character.

Rune Carver Personality Traits

d6	Personality Trait
1	Is it practical to learn an ancient language that is rarely spoken? No. But is it fun? Very.
2	I learned one of my ancestors was a lauded rune carver whose story was lost to time. I seek to rekindle that legacy.
3	The old, traditional markings of runecraft look so boring. Why not give my runes some flair?
4	In my studies of runes, I strive to understand how great civilizations of the past fell, so I can prevent it from happening to societies of the present.
5	Life may be a whirlwind of chaos, but whenever I create my runes, I feel at peace.
6	My brain struggles to process words written in ink, but the feeling of carved runes makes my mind sing.

Big Heroes, Big Stories

The remnants of giants' power, ancient and strong, echo throughout the worlds, touching the lives of individuals regardless of their background. This section provides various ways to narratively tie your character to the myth and might of giants.

Heroes of the Giants

Barbarians who harness the might of giants are not the only adventurers who draw power from giants. A character of any class can explore ties to giants in the following ways.

Elements and Environments

If your spells or class features draw on elemental forces or the magic of the land, you might use a connection to giants to tap into that power. A druid belonging to the Circle of the Land might feel a connection to the giants who inhabit that land. A monk who follows the Way of the Four Elements might seek to emulate Annam, the All-Father, to shape and channel the forces of the Elemental Chaos.

Giant Ancestors

You might be distantly descended from giants and manifest the power of your ancestors in your class features or magic, which might explain your Rage as a barbarian or your spellcasting as a sorcerer.

Giant Foes

Your character's relationship to giants might be defined by animosity. You could choose class features specifically to target giants or all creatures with the Giant type, or you could write enmity toward giants into the tenets of your paladin's Sacred Oath.

Giant Lore

You might have learned magic, martial techniques, or other secrets from studying giants, either ancient or living. Your character might strive to unearth and record more of the ancient history of giants or to learn more of their present ways. This could be a matter of personal motivation, but it also might explain some of your class features or magic. A bard of the College of Lore might focus on the study of giants, a Rune Knight fighter (from *Tasha's Cauldron of Everything*) might use the magic of Giant runes, or a paladin's Sacred Oath could involve allegiance to the tenets of a philosophy or organization of giants (such as those described in chapter 2).

Giant-Made Accessories

You might use a giant-crafted item—probably something inscribed with one or more Giant runes—as a spellcasting focus. For example, the staff you wield as an arcane focus might have been a giant's wand. Your wizard's spellbook might be a relic from an ancient realm of giants, perhaps a large and heavy tome mostly written in the Giant language. Or you might wield a weapon that a giant intended for a different use, such as a giant's letter opener that works as a sword or a giant's hatchet that serves you as a greataxe. Perhaps you have learned to play a giant's violin as if it were a cello or use a musical instrument made for a giant child.



A druid summons a primeval beast.

Gods of the Giants

Your character might worship one of the gods described in chapter 2. If you were reared by giants, they might have taught you their faith. Perhaps one of those gods called you to fulfill a specific purpose. Alternatively, you could worship one of the so-called "interloper gods" (also described in chapter 2) who often take an interest in giants, or one of those entities might be your warlock's Otherworldly Patron.

Mentors and Patrons

Perhaps you had a giant as a mentor or a financial benefactor who taught you your profession or your class or provided you with your starting equipment. If you have a continuing obligation to this giant, see "Giant Patrons" in chapter 3 for additional inspiration.

Primeval Animals

You could have a connection with giant-sized or prehistoric animals. You might call on the spirits of cave bears, dire wolves, or eagle-eyed pteranodons, or you might use your magic to take the shapes of such creatures. Or you could have a dinosaur companion.

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Birthplaces and Hometowns

Your character might hail from a location steeped in giants' history and primordial magic. From ancient ruins to underground caverns to elemental nexuses, this section provides various locales to tie to your character's backstory.

Ancient Giant Ruins

You grew up amid the ruins of one of the giants' civilizations. Perhaps the history of your home settlement is well-known, with lauded scholars traveling to the site to conduct archaeological research. Or maybe its origins are a mystery, your only clues being the strange, oversized objects occasionally found in the nearby land.

Giant Trinket. While exploring your home, you discovered some trivial remnant of the ancient inhabitants, as determined by rolling on the Giant Trinkets table. The items in parentheses are the normal-sized objects most analogous to the described giant trinkets.

Giant Trinkets

d6	Giant Trinket
1	A giant's toothpick (a dagger)
2	A giant's handkerchief (a blanket)
3	A giant's marble (a crystal orb)
4	A giant's match (a torch)
5	A giant's letter opener (a longsword)
6	A giant's thimble (an iron pot)



A character raised in the ruins of giant civilization uses giant-made tools.

Primordial Nexus

You grew up surrounded by powerful elemental magic. Maybe you lived in a place where the border between the Material Plane and an Elemental Plane was thin. Or perhaps you spent your formative years traversing the Elemental Planes as a merchant or scholar, visiting fantastic locations such as the City of Brass on the Plane of Fire or the Labyrinth Winds of the Plane of Air.

In any case, your time spent among these elemental forces deeply affected you. The Material Plane feels mundane and controlled, especially when you have experienced firsthand the churning chaos of the primordial elements.

Elemental Mark. Your exposure to primordial elemental magic has altered you physically in some small way, determined by rolling on the Elemental Marks table.

Elemental Marks

d6	Mark
1	Small, benign motes of elemental energy, like pebbles or water droplets, float around your head.
2	Your skin harmlessly feels blazing hot or freezing cold (your choice).
3	You have a faint scent reminiscent of your primordial nexus home, like petrichor, ozone, or smoke.
4	Sparks flicker in your eyes whenever you are angry or excited.
5	Patches of your skin are veined with stone, like marble or obsidian.
6	Your hair ripples as if moved by an unseen current.

Sequestered Caverns

You spent your formative years deep beneath the ground, sequestered far from the sun and wind of the surface.

You may have encountered giants during your time underground—particularly families of gentle stone giants or talented smithing guilds of fire giants. To you, the surface world is just a long-forgotten memory or distant dream.

Underground Quirk. Your time spent underground has changed you in some way, as determined by rolling on the Underground Quirks table.

Underground Quirks

d6	Quirk
1	You've seen few colors, instead primarily experiencing the world in shades of black and white.
2	Your eyes lack pigment and appear translucent.
3	You vaguely recall a phenomenon called "rain," during which fresh water fell from above.
4	Your ears are used to the echo of empty caverns, and the bustling noises of the surface are distracting for you.
5	The idea of a space with no ceiling terrifies you.
6	You're desperate to touch a cloud. You don't know what it will feel like, but you hope it's fluffy.

Tall Tales

Some folks are content to merely listen to stories of giants and other enormous peoples and creatures. For others, these tall tales become the basis of their entire adventuring career. Such individuals find themselves gripped by legends of giants, spurred to embark on dangerous quests in search of truth or vindication.

Myths about giants vary across the worlds. The Tall Tales table provides ideas for legends of—or encounters with—giant creatures that may have inspired your character to begin adventuring.

Tall Tales

d6	Tall Tale Connection
1	You stumbled into a giant castle in the sky when you were younger, but no one believed your story. You aim to prove them wrong.
2	A loved one died mysteriously at sea. You swore the culprit was a sea leviathan everyone else dismissed as a myth, and you seek vindication and revenge.
3	Stories say you're descended from a legendary giant-killer, and you strive to uphold that legacy.
4	A city's legends claim the neighboring landscape is the work of some ancient giant sculptor or rampaging titanic beast—or is itself a sleeping giant. You seek to discover the truth of the land's origin.
5	A relative once returned home claiming to have found a strange island inhabited by ancient, larger-than-life creatures. Because of this, your family became the town laughingstock, and you seek to redeem your family's reputation.
6	Your sibling says giants and other enormous creatures are stories for children. You hope to slay such a creature and bring back proof of their existence out of spite.

Feats

The following section presents a variety of feats linked to giants and their magic.

Feat Descriptions

The feats are presented in alphabetical order. If a feat has a prerequisite, you must meet that prerequisite to gain the feat.

Ember of the Fire Giant

Prerequisite: 4th Level, Strike of the Giants (Fire Strike) Feat

You've manifested the fiery combat emblematic of fire giants, granting you the following benefits:

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength, Constitution, or Wisdom score by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Born of Flame. You have resistance to fire damage.

Searing Ignition. When you take the Attack action on your turn, you can replace a single attack with a magical burst of flame. Each creature of your choice in a 15-foot-radius sphere centered on you must make a Dexterity saving throw (DC equals 8 + your proficiency bonus + the modifier of the ability increased by this feat). On a failed save, a creature takes fire damage equal to 1d8 + your proficiency bonus, and it has the blinded condition until the start of your next turn. On a successful save, the creature takes half as much damage only. You can use your Searing Ignition a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus (but no more than once per turn), and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Fury of the Frost Giant

Prerequisite: 4th Level, Strike of the Giants (Frost Strike) Feat

You've manifested the icy might emblematic of frost giants, granting you the following benefits:

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength, Constitution, or Wisdom score by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Born of Ice. You have resistance to cold damage.

Frigid Retaliation. Immediately after a creature you can see within 30 feet of you hits you with an attack roll and deals damage, you can use your reaction to retaliate with a conjured blast of ice. The creature must make a Constitution saving throw (DC equals 8 + your proficiency bonus + the modifier of the ability increased by this feat). On a failed save, the creature takes cold damage equal to 1d8 + your proficiency bonus, and its speed is reduced to 0 until the end of its next turn. You can use this reaction a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Guile of the Cloud Giant

Prerequisite: 4th Level, Strike of the Giants (Cloud Strike) Feat

You've manifested the confounding magic emblematic of cloud giants, granting you the following benefits:

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength, Constitution, or Charisma score by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Cloudy Escape. When a creature you can see hits you with an attack roll, you can use your reaction to give yourself resistance to that attack's damage. You then teleport to an unoccupied space that you can see within 30 feet of yourself. You can use this reaction a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Keenness of the Stone Giant

Prerequisite: 4th Level, Strike of the Giants (Stone Strike) Feat

You've manifested the physical talents emblematic of stone giants, granting you the following benefits:

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength, Constitution, or Wisdom score by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Cavernous Sight. You gain darkvision with a range of 60 feet. If you already have darkvision from another source, its range increases by 60 feet.

Stone Throw. As a bonus action, you can take a rock and make a magical attack with it. The attack is a ranged spell attack with a range of 60 feet that uses the ability score you increased with this feat as the spellcasting ability. On a hit, the rock deals 1d10 force damage, and the target must succeed on a Strength saving throw (DC equals 8 + your proficiency bonus + the spellcasting ability modifier) or have the prone condition. You can use this bonus action a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Rune Shaper

Prerequisite: Spellcasting Feature or Rune Carver Background

You've studied the magic of Giant runes, granting you the following benefits:

Comprehend Languages. You learn the *comprehend languages* spell. You can cast this spell without expending a spell slot, and you must finish a long rest before you can cast it in this way again. You can also cast this spell using any spell slots you have.

Rune Magic. You know a number of runes equal to half your proficiency bonus (rounded down), chosen from the Rune Spells table. Whenever you finish a long rest, you can inscribe each rune you know onto one nonmagical weapon, armor, piece of clothing, or other object you touch. You temporarily learn the 1st-level spells that correspond to the runes you inscribed, as specified on the Rune Spells table, and you know those spells until you finish a long rest, when the runes fade. While you are wearing or carrying any rune-marked object, you can cast the spells associated with those runes using any spell slots you have.

You can also invoke a rune inscribed on an object you are wearing or carrying and cast its associated spell without expending a spell slot or using material components. Once you cast the spell in this way, you can't do so again until you finish a long rest. Your spellcasting ability for this feat is Intelligence, Wisdom, or Charisma (choose when you select this feat).

Each time you gain a level, you can replace one of the runes you know with another one from the Rune Spells table.



Fury of the Frost Giant

Rune Spells

Rune	Spell
Cloud	*Fog cloud*
Death	*Inflict wounds*
Dragon	*Chromatic orb*
Enemy	*Disguise self*
Fire	*Burning hands*
Friend	*Speak with animals*
Frost	*Armor of Agathys*
Hill	*Goodberry*
Journey	*Longstrider*
King	*Command*
Mountain	*Entangle*
Stone	*Sanctuary*
Storm	*Thunderwave*

Soul of the Storm Giant

Prerequisite: 4th Level, Strike of the Giants (Storm Strike) Feat

You've manifested the tempest magic emblematic of storm giants, granting you the following benefits:

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength, Wisdom, or Charisma score by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Maelstrom Aura. As a bonus action, you surround yourself with an aura of magical wind and lightning that extends 10 feet from you in every direction but not through total cover. The aura lasts until the start of your next turn or until you are incapacitated. While the aura is active, you have resistance to lightning and thunder damage. In addition, attack rolls against you have disadvantage, and whenever another creature starts its turn within the aura, you can force the creature to make a Strength saving throw (DC equals 8 + your proficiency bonus + the ability modifier of the score increased by this feat). On a failed save, the creature's speed is halved until the start of its next turn. You can use this bonus action a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Strike of the Giants

Prerequisite: Martial Weapon Proficiency or Giant Foundling Background

You have absorbed primeval magic that gives you an echo of the might of giants. When you take this feat, choose one of the benefits listed below. Once per turn, when you hit a target with a melee weapon attack or a ranged weapon attack using a thrown weapon, you can imbue the attack with an additional effect depending on the benefit you chose:

Cloud Strike. The target takes an extra 1d4 thunder damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw, or you become invisible to it until the start of your next turn or until immediately after you make an attack roll or cast a spell.

Fire Strike. The target takes an extra 1d10 fire damage.

Frost Strike. The target takes an extra 1d6 cold damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a Constitution saving throw, or its speed is reduced to 0 until the start of your next turn.

Hill Strike. The target takes an extra 1d6 damage of the weapon's type. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a Strength saving throw or have the prone condition.

Stone Strike. The target takes an extra 1d6 force damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a Strength saving throw or be pushed 10 feet from you in a straight line.

Storm Strike. The target takes an extra 1d6 lightning damage. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a Constitution saving throw, or it has disadvantage on attack rolls until the start of your next turn.

The saving throw DC for these effects equals 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Strength or Constitution modifier.

You can use this feat a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Vigor of the Hill Giant

Prerequisite: 4th Level, Strike of the Giants (Hill Strike) Feat

You've manifested the resilience emblematic of hill giants, granting you the following benefits:

Ability Score Increase. Increase your Strength, Constitution, or Wisdom score by 1, to a maximum of 20.

Bulwark. When you are subjected to an effect that would move you at least 5 feet or give you the prone condition, you can use your reaction to steady yourself. You aren't moved and don't have the prone condition.

Iron Stomach. Whenever you eat food as part of a short rest and spend one or more Hit Dice to regain hit points, you regain additional hit points equal to your Constitution modifier + your proficiency bonus.

